

More waste separated, but how much recycled?

A public claim, tested against Eurostat, NSO and EU targets

THE CLAIM

“Malta continues to make strong progress in waste management.”

Ministry for the Environment, press release PR260072en, 19 January 2026

Minister Dalli: the waste plan “is working”; 412 million kg diverted from landfill in five years.

EU targets are measured on waste actually recycled after sorting, not on kilograms separated.

VERDICT

NOT SUBSTANTIATED

Separation is up; only 16.7% was recycled in 2024.

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

+7.6 pts

Recycling rate since 2019

From 9.1% to 16.7%: the 4th-largest rise of 20 EU states. Packaging recycling jumped in 2023.

16.7%

Actually recycled, 2024

Of municipal waste. EU average 48%. The 2025 target is 55%; Malta renounced a postponement.

79%

Still landfilled

Of treated municipal waste in 2024. The 2020 target was missed by a wide margin.

412 vs 271

Thousand tonnes

Ministry’s “diverted” figure vs Eurostat’s recycled or recovered waste, 2020–24.

0 t

Organic waste recycled

None counted, 2019–24: treated biowaste is used for landscaping and landfill remediation, so it is reported as landfilled.

FAIR TO SAY

Malta’s recycling rate is rising faster than in most EU states, and the deposit scheme coincided with a jump in packaging recycling. The direction is right; the claim is about how far it has got.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ Scope, years and method behind 412 million kg.

☐ How much separated waste is rejected and landfilled.

☐ Where compost and digestate go, and when they will count.

☐ The year Malta expects to reach 55% recycled.